The ***Navya-Nyaya*** philosopher *Raghunatha* argues that number is a separate category of reality (***padartha***), not a variety of quality, because we ascribe number to qualities. Numbers apply to objects in a way different from that in which universals and qualities do. A number applies to a group (for example, eleven footballers) collectively. It is not related distributively to each member (as when we say, 'the birds are singing' we mean that each bird is singing) because it is not the case that each member of the team is eleven. The relation of a number to a collection is of a unique type that he calls 'comprehension' (*paryapti*). The attribution of number depends upon the mind counting and grouping individuals. This does not mean that numbers are subjective impositions: two exists and we perceive pairs, three exists and we perceive triads.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Ganeri 2001a; Ingalls 1951; Matilal 2002b

Samnyasa (renunciation of social and religious duty): the renunciation of ritual religion and caste status. It is formalised through a special type of initiation ritual. Initially this may have been an expression of the endless repetitions characterising the everyday life of the adult male householder with his duties of wealth creation, procreation and the performance and patronage of rituals. But it was integrated into mainstream religion and classified as the fourth stage of life (***ashrama***) additional to those of celibate studentship, being a householder (*grihastha*) and retirement or 'forest-dwelling' (*vanaprastha*). The ideal of ultimate liberation (***moksha***) from the series of births was sometimes defined as the duty (*svadharma*) of the renouncer. It is accepted that detached and self-controlled individuals of unusual virtue may renounce without having lived as householders.